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THE ULTRA-EGO

This one turns rugged hardware into a truly intelligent assistant inside a familiar titanium shell

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Unlike its counterparts, the Apple Watch Ultra 4 does not suffer from an identity crisis. It knows what it is. A rugged smartwatch, serious fitness tracker, health monitor and increasingly, a tiny AI assistant quietly strapped to your wrist.

Design

Apple has wisely resisted redesigning the Ultra simply for the sake of it. The 49mm titanium case remains big, purposeful and unapologetically rugged, available in natural and black titanium. It is built for dust, water, diving and the occasional encounter with reality. The Action button remains one of the Ultra's smartest physical controls, particularly when your fingers are wet, sweaty or wearing gloves.

Display

The 49mm Always-On Retina OLED display remains superb. With up to 3,000 nits brightness and a sapphire crystal, it is designed to stay readable outdoors, where lesser displays can start looking like they have called in sick.

Performance

However, the biggest upgrade is beneath the surface. The new Health Sensing System measures heart rate every five seconds and captures HRV up to 24 times more frequently. There is also a new Readiness score that combines activity, training load, vitals and sleep into a daily 0 to 10 assessments.

Battery life gets a welcome boost too. Ultra 4 can deliver up to 50 hours of everyday use, 84 hours in Low Power Mode and up to 45 hours of outdoor workout tracking. Fifteen minutes of charging can add up to 18 hours of battery life.

Verdict

At Rs 1,09,900, this remains a serious luxury smartwatch. But Ultra 4 feels less like a cosmetic upgrade and more like a smarter evolution. It does not reinvent the Ultra. It simply makes it highly responsive, deeply health-conscious and exceptionally reliable.